

“What about graduation expenses and the school loans?” Andrea asked apprehensively. She had intended to tell Bill about the other debts, but now she wondered if she should.

“He said he’ll continue to pay until I graduate, and they’re going to give us two thousand dollars as a wedding gift to help us get started. The school loans are mine to pay, but I knew that from the beginning.”

Andrea decided she would wait to tell Bill about the debts until he had a chance to recover from the shock of telling his parents. The opportunity didn’t come up again before graduation, and with the wedding money from Bill’s parents they were able to get by for the next month.

Bill found a job as a cashier in a music store. Although it didn’t pay much, he figured he could find something better after the summer break, when all the other students went back to school.

One evening Bill answered the doorbell, and there stood Andrea’s mother. “Mrs. Carlisle, come in. What a nice surprise!” he said.

“Bill, I need to talk with you and Andrea about something urgent. Is she here?”

“Yes, she is,” he replied. At that moment Andrea came around the door from the bedroom saying, “Who’s at the door, Bill?” When she saw her mother, she paled.

“Mother, what are you doing here?” she asked in a hollow voice.

“Andrea, you know very well what I’m doing here,” her mother answered. “It’s about these.” With that, she thrust a handful of credit card receipts in front of her. “You told me you were going to take care of these, and now I have received notice that the bank is filing suit against me.”

“What are those?” Bill asked as Andrea made her way back to the living room couch.

“They’re credit card bills,” Andrea’s mother said in an accusing tone. “Didn’t Andrea tell you I called her about them nearly two months ago?”